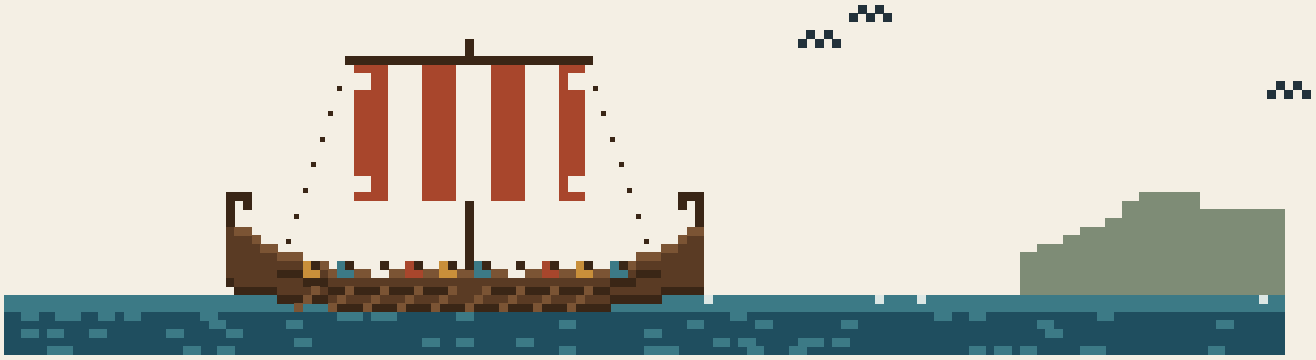
OAR AND EMBER

06 / Voyages, Raids and Consequences

A small set of complete scenarios that prove the central loop: lead, preparation, risk, return and consequence.



If these nine scenarios are fun, fair and different from each other, the game works. Each one is specified completely enough to build, test and balance before the map grows.

HOW TO USE THIS SET

Build Scenario 1 for Build 2, Scenarios 2 and 3 for Build 3, and the rest during the campaign stages. Each scenario lists its hidden true state, what the player can know, approaches, complications, extraction, outcome bands, consequences and the tests that prove it. Quantities are starting values for balancing, not final numbers.

Specification, not implemented content. All places and people are fictional. Violence is graphic and the player can kill civilians and the surrendered; consequences depend on witnesses and evidence. No children appear as actors in any scene; families are implied by homes, belongings and adults. Numbers here are illustrative; Book 10 is authoritative.

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01 / How a scenario is built

Every voyage or raid uses the same template, so content can be authored as data and tested the same way.

Part	Contents
Lead	How the player hears of it, from whom, and with what confidence
True state	What is really there: stores, people, defences, sacred objects, local disputes, supernatural facts. Hidden in the save.
Known intel	What the player can learn before landing, each item with source and confidence (rumour, likely, certain)
Preparation	Landing, timing, crew, equipment, aim, and one preparation advantage
Approaches	At least three viable ways to reach the aim, plus withdrawal
Complications	One or two changes drawn from the true state, never stacked beyond two on early raids
Extraction	Getting people and cargo to the boat and away; berths and cargo slots
Outcome bands	Named results, each a meaningful result rather than pass or fail
Evidence	Bodies, dropped gear, tracks and burned buildings left behind, and when they will be found
Consequences	Immediate, at home, regional, among the crew, and delayed
Proof tests	What a scripted or human test must show for the scenario to pass its gate

Cargo and berths

Every lot of cargo takes one slot: grain, iron, silver, timber, salt, cloth. Livestock take two slots per pen. People use berths; a passenger beyond the berths takes two cargo slots. The starting coastal boat has **8 berths** and **4 cargo slots** (5 with the cargo fitting from Chapter 1). One grain lot is fifty ration-days: ten days for a household of five.

Deed tags

Outcomes write **deeds** to the coast's memory. A deed records what happened, where, who witnessed it, and the sail and marks that identified the doer. The core vocabulary:

Deed tag	Meaning
`THEFT`	Goods taken without violence or threat
`THREAT`	Goods yielded under threat of violence
`TRIBUTE_TAKEN`	Payment accepted to spare a place
`FAIR_TRADE`	Goods exchanged at a fair rate
`KILLING`	Defenders killed in a fight (count and names recorded)
`CIVILIAN_KILLED`	Non-combatants killed: farmers, monks, traders, keepers, servants
`SURRENDERED_KILLED`	People killed after surrendering or while downed
`SACRILEGE`	Blood spilled or goods taken at a sacred place
`SPARED`	Defenders or people spared when they could have been killed
`BURNING`	Buildings, boats or stores burned
`SEED_TAKEN` / `SEED_LEFT`	Winter or seed stores taken or knowingly left
`SACRED_TAKEN`	A relic, offering or grave good removed

Deed tag	Meaning
`RESCUE`	People freed or taken away at their own request
`HOSTAGE_TAKEN`	A named person held as a guarantee or for ransom
`PROMISE_MADE` / `PROMISE_KEPT` / `PROMISE_BROKEN`	Agreements and their fate
`SAIL_SEEN`	The household's sail and marks recognised

02 / Scenario 1: The Carrick Storehouse

Chapter 2. The first raid. Small, readable, and full of choices. A storehouse and landing on the Irish coast that serves Ardcarn.

Lead

After the launch, the sea map shows smoke on the Irish coast. Oddi's chart fragment, salvaged from Thorkel's chest, marks a landing called Carrick with the note "grain, iron, few spears". The island needs provisions and iron for nails and tools. **Confidence:** likely.

The place

A shingle beach with a timber jetty, a stone-footed storehouse, the keeper's house, a byre, a drying rack for fish and a watch post on the headland. A cart track leads inland to Ardcarn. A runner who gets off the map brings Fiachra's riders, quartered at Ardcarn, back in about two minutes (Book 9 section 07). Low tide doubles the carry from the storehouse to a boat on the beach; high tide lets the boat lie at the jetty.

True state

Element	Truth
Grain	Six lots. Two are winter seed for Ardcarn's spring sowing, marked with Brigid's cross. One lot is Kilbrecc's tithe.
Iron	Two lots of bar iron bought from Saltvik.
Silver	One lot hidden under the keeper's hearth: Muiredach's tribute to King Fiachra.
Boat	The keeper's small currach at the jetty. Can be towed (two extra slots, slower, may be lost in rough water).
Defenders	Colla the keeper (old, will not fight unless his house is entered), three guards with spears, one young herdsman who runs for Ardcarn if alarmed.
Guest	Eithne, delivering the season's tally. She wants to leave with whoever is going.
Watch	Two guards by day, one at night; the night guard sleeps at the turn of the tide. Dogs only after a first raid.

Known intel and how to improve it

Without scouting: grain and iron, few spears. **Scout the shore** (Oddi or Hild, half a day): guard count, the night guard's habit, the marked seed sacks, the runner. **Ask a trader** (if Saltvik visited first, not possible in Build 2): the iron was owed to Kilbrecc's smith. Captured or friendly locals can tell the rest.

Preparation

Choose up to five landing-party members (others stay with the boat), timing (dawn, day, dusk, night; tide high or low) and **one preparation advantage**: scout the shore, bring trade goods (salvage from the wreck: an amber necklace, a silver arm-ring, good rope) or bring extra fighting equipment (spare shields and spears for everyone ashore).

Approaches

Approach	How it plays	Best conditions
Steal	Land at the far end of the beach, slip past the night guard, carry lots to the boat. Discovery turns it into a chase to the boat.	Night, high tide, scouting done
Bargain	Walk up openly with trade goods. Colla will trade surplus grain and one iron lot, but not seed or tithe without Muiredach's word.	Trade goods brought; Bran or Eithne speaks
Threaten	Arrive armed and in force by day. Colla yields stores to protect his house. The runner leaves regardless.	Extra weapons; full landing party; the feared sail
Fight	Attack the guards. Colla surrenders when two guards fall or flee.	Extra weapons; dawn
Slaughter	Kill everyone found, including Colla and the herdsman. Killing the runner before he leaves the map stops the patrol.	Full landing party; night or dawn
Withdraw	Always available from the plan or at the boat.	Any time the plan has failed

Complications (one drawn per seed)

- **The Crows arrive.** Ulf's black sail beaches beside yours. He demands half and his men start killing the guards. The player can join, stand aside, or stop them. Stopping them earns `SPARED` and Ulf's enmity; standing aside writes Ulf's killings into the ledger with your sail present.
- **The defenders offer payment.** Colla offers the hidden silver if you leave the grain and the houses alone. Accepting is `TRIBUTE_TAKEN`: Carrick will pay again next year, and Fiachra loses his own tribute.
- **The patrol.** If the runner reaches Ardcarn and the party stays past a visible horn signal, four of Fiachra's riders arrive. A time-pressure extraction, not an ambush.

Two features are always present and are not complications: the **seed sacks** (a discovered choice) and **Eithne** (an offered person).

Extraction

The coastal boat has three free berths and four or five cargo slots. Available: six grain, two iron, one silver, the towed currach. Eithne takes a berth. A wounded crew member carried to the boat takes the carrier out of the fight. Rowing clear while defenders gather on the beach is part of the scene.

Outcome bands

Band	Typical haul	Deeds and immediate effects
Clean theft	3 to 4 grain, 1 iron	`THEFT`. Carrick does not know whose sail until morning. Food runway roughly 30 days longer.
Fair bargain	2 grain, 1 iron	`FAIR_TRADE`. Colla becomes a contact; Ardcarn regard rises; next visit offers trade first.

Band	Typical haul	Deeds and immediate effects
Taken by threat	4 grain, 2 iron	`THREAT`, `SAIL_SEEN`. Fiachra is shamed: his client was not protected.
Hard fight	Up to full slots	`KILLING` with named dead. Ardcarn hostile; Muirenn records it; Bran disapproves unless the guards struck first.
Paid to leave	1 silver, 1 to 2 grain	`TRIBUTE_TAKEN`. Expectation of a yearly payment; Fiachra's tribute lost.
Massacre	Up to full slots	`CIVILIAN_KILLED`, `KILLING`. If anyone escapes or the bodies are linked to the household, Ardcarn and Dún Fiach turn hostile on sight. Most of the crew are shaken; Kári is not.
Withdrawal	0 to 1 lots	Possibly `SAIL_SEEN`. Everyone comes home. A lead to try another way.

Consequences

At home. Iron becomes nails and tools: the boat's hull patch is made permanent and a simple forge can be built. Grain becomes breathing room shown in the steward's report. Eithne at the fire, if she came. Stolen silver attracts an offer or accusation at the next harbour.

Regional. Ardcarn's winter stores fall by what was taken. A taken currach means Ardcarn's fishing suffers. After any raid Carrick posts two more guards and keeps dogs. The runner's news reaches Fiachra in three days and Kilbrecc in five. Saltvik's traders hear within ten days, which shifts prices and gossip.

Crew. Bran approves bargains and mercy, Hild approves bold success and everyone coming home, Oddi approves the haul, Runa approves the iron. Every approach pleases someone and troubles someone.

Evidence. Bodies at Carrick are found by Ardcarn the next morning. They link the deed to the household if gear was dropped, if a body bears a recognisable wound pattern from a known weapon, or if a fisherman offshore saw the sail (a chance in Book 10). With no escaping witness and no link, Ardcarn knows only that someone did it, and blames the nearest raiders: Ulf.

Delayed. `SEED_TAKEN`: Ardcarn's spring sowing fails in Year 2, bringing hungry refugees, a desperate Muiredach and hired swords. `SEED_LEFT` (if anyone at Ardcarn learns of it): Muiredach remembers the mercy at the council. Taking the tithe grain makes Kilbrecc an aggrieved party. Taking the silver makes Fiachra one. A known massacre empties half of Ardcarn's fields the next spring, makes Muiredach an implacable enemy and closes the Carrick Strand site to anything but conquest.

Leads offered on return

Saltvik (sell or trade, Runa's sister, ship fittings) and Glen Arra (cattle, and a rumour that the Crows are planning something there).

Proof tests

1. Each approach can finish with at least one food lot or a lasting non-material gain such as a contact.
2. Withdrawal is reachable from every state of the scene.
3. Leaving the seed produces a positive delayed consequence by Chapter 5 if witnessed; taking it produces a negative one.
4. Threat and fight bands schedule a retaliation that a player can see coming.
5. Two leads are offered on return in every band, including withdrawal.
6. A new player completes the raid in 12 to 20 minutes.

03 / Scenario 2: The Light in the Fog

Chapter 3 voyage interruption. A light in Manannán's mist, a price that sounds cheap, and the arrival of Nessa.

Lead and trigger

On any crossing in Chapter 3 after the Saltvik visit, the moving mist closes over the route. A steady light appears ahead that does not flicker like a flame.

True state

The light is the Ferryman's lamp. Manannán is curious about the household that his mist both hid and wrecked. Following it leads to a seal skerry where Nessa is stranded (Watcher or Bound stances) or to a quick passage home with Nessa found later in a coracle on Wreck Strand (Runaway stance).

Choices

Choice	Result
Follow the light	The Ferryman's boat comes alongside. He offers to guide them out for a price.
Sail on by reckoning	A rock-strewn passage scene: steering and lookout choices; hull damage likely; Nessa found anyway, later.
Anchor and wait	One day lost, stores consumed; the mist lifts; Nessa found later.

The Ferryman's price (choose one)

- **A true story.** The player tells something true about an earlier voyage. The crew hears it. Truth about a shameful deed troubles Glory-minded crew and earns Word-minded respect.
- **A gift freely given.** One cargo lot dropped over the side. No haggling: haggling withdraws the offer.
- **A promise of hospitality.** The household will take in the next stranger who comes to them from the sea. This is saved as a bargain with Manannán. The next stranger is Thrand Halfhand in Chapter 4. Turning him away breaks the promise: the mist will never help the household again.

Consequences

Nessa joins or is met. A bargain or gift recorded with Manannán. The mist on the sea map can later be entered deliberately for escape or shortcut, once per season, if the household has kept faith. **Proof tests:** each choice reaches home within one day; the promise branch demonstrably binds Thrand's arrival; no choice leads to death.

04 / Scenario 3: Saltvik Market Day

Chapter 3. A trade voyage with no raid at all: proof that the loop works without violence and that the coast remembers.

Lead

Offered on return from Carrick. Runa wants to find her sister; the household needs fittings, salt and news.

What is there

Stall or person	Offers	Wants
Gunnhild's yard	Ship fittings (cargo, rigging, shallow draft) and repairs	Silver, iron, a share of salvage rights
Ottar Silkbeard	Bulk salt, cloth, buyers for anything	Profit; tells you Orm's ships were seen in the north
The sea-wife	A wind-knot cord (three knots)	Silver, or a lock of the steerer's hair
Kolbeinn the smith	Himself, if his debt is cleared	His debt paid, won at dice, or his creditors driven off
Asa, Runa's sister	Gratitude, a contact in Ottar's counting-house	Her own debt settled
Hiring bench	Oarsmen for one voyage	Silver and a share; they leave if the voyage goes badly

Recognition

Goods from Carrick can be recognised. Grain sacks with Brigid's cross, bar iron with Kilbrecc's smith's mark, Muiredach's silver. A Kilbrecc lay brother at the market notices. Selling those goods openly records a `SAIL_SEEN` with Kilbrecc and lowers the price; if Saltvik is hostile, its guards attack on sight at the jetty and the market is closed; selling quietly through Ottar costs a cut. Ulf's men may be here collecting Kolbeinn's debt or Oddi's, depending on earlier choices.

Outcome and proof

The player leaves with at least one fitting, one new resident or one contact, and a clear next lead (Glen Arra, Kilbrecc, or a cargo run for Ottar). **Proof tests:** a player who never fights can still finish the market with a fitting and a resident; stolen goods are recognised by their marks; the wind-knot works exactly as specified in Book 4.

05 / Scenario 4: The Glen Arra Cattle

Chapter 3 or 4. Ulf plans to lift Glen Arra's cattle. The household can join him, warn the glen, beat him to it, or broker a deal.

True state

Glen Arra has twelve cattle on the summer grazing at the loch head, guarded by Áine and two herders. Ulf plans to land at dawn in two days with fifteen men. Gilla Muire's main household is an hour away.

Approaches

Approach	Play	Result
Join Ulf	A shared raid. Ulf takes the lead and the larger share.	Livestock (two slots per pen); `THREAT` or `KILLING` shared; Ulf's regard up; Glen Arra hostile
Warn and defend	Sail in first; hold the narrow shore path with Áine	A defensive fight; `SPARED` if Ulf's men are allowed to retreat; Áine may join; Ulf becomes an enemy
Raid first	Use a shallow draft fitting to reach the loch head before Ulf	Most cattle if fast; Ulf and Glen Arra both angered
Broker	Persuade Ulf to take a payment from Gilla Muire instead	Requires Ulf's respect or a shared enemy; earns a fee from both; fragile

Extraction

Cattle must be driven to the shore and loaded; a coastal boat carries at most two pens. Swimming cattle out to a karvi is slow and loud. Leftover cattle are a choice: leave them, kill them (`BURNING`-class waste), or give them back.

Consequences

Áine and Arra Foot (Chapter 6 site) open only through warning or brokering. Ulf's path splits here. **Proof tests:** each approach leaves the region in a different state; brokering is reachable only with prerequisites the player can see; cattle extraction respects slots.

06 / Scenario 5: The Bell of Brecc

Chapter 4. A monastery, a relic, a man who was here before, and the biggest consequences in the early game.

True state

Kilbrecc has a round tower where the community takes refuge, a church, a guesthouse, workshops, a farm and stores. The Bell of Brecc hangs in the church in a shrine-case of silver. Abbot Colmán will hide the Bell in the tower if warned. Sister Muirenn keeps the annals in the tower. About thirty monks and lay brothers; few fighters. Sanctuary is claimed by anyone who reaches the church.

Known intel

Rumour says the monastery is rich. Bran knows the layout from fifteen years ago and does not want to go. Senán, if a contact, can tell the truth about how little silver there is and how much the Bell matters.

Approaches

Approach	Play	Notes
Take the Bell	Reach the church before it is hidden, or besiege the tower	`SACRED_TAKEN`. The largest consequences in Chapters 1 to 4.
Raid the farm, spare the church	Take stores and livestock from the farm buildings	`THEFT` or `THREAT`; the church records restraint
Demand tribute	Arrive in force; Colmán pays in stores and some silver	`TRIBUTE_TAKEN`; Kilbrecc keeps the Bell
Borrow the Bell	Offer protection for a season in exchange for carrying the Bell aboard on one named voyage	A `PROMISE_MADE` with the Church; returning it on time earns deep trust
Leave	Trade at the guesthouse, or simply go	Bran's relief; Senán's respect

Bran at Kilbrecc

If Bran comes ashore, Muirenn recognises him. He can confess, which changes Kilbrecc's view of the household and Bran's own arc, or deny it, which works until someone checks the annals.

The Bell aboard

While aboard, the Bell calms water: storms on the sea map are one step weaker, and the boat is faster in rough seas. But **Breccán's drowned crew follow it**. Signs: fog every night, wet footprints on the deck, figures standing in the shallows wherever the ship anchors. They grow bolder each night until the Bell is returned or rung over the Cauldron at slack water, which releases them and is one of the three keys to breaking Orm's bargain. Ringing it there without the Church's leave still counts, but Kilbrecc must hear why.

Consequences

`SACRED_TAKEN` makes Kilbrecc an aggrieved party with a demand at the council, may bring an interdict that closes Christian markets, and raises the Glory and Gain crew while troubling Faith (Christian) and Mercy crew. Borrowing it creates the game's clearest test of a promise. **Proof tests:** the drowned escalate predictably and stop when the Bell is returned or rung; every approach is completable; Bran's recognition fires only when he lands.

07 / Scenario 6: The Tribute Ship

Chapter 4. A sea battle against Asgrim's tribute ship carrying silver and hostages from a harbour Orm has taken.

Lead

Thrand (if aboard), Ottar or a fisherman reports a heavy ship sailing south under a grey sail. Two escorts were scattered by weather.

True state

One ship, eighteen crew, Asgrim aboard. Cargo: three silver lots and four hostages from the taken harbour, held below the half-deck. A sealed message in Heid's hand tells Asgrim to give "two for the Reach" if the weather turns. Asgrim does not know what the message says.

The battle

1. **Approach.** On the sea map, choose to close with the wind, cut across from the weather gauge, or wait in the mist. Wind and tide decide who reaches the approach first.
2. **Missiles.** In the battle scene, both ships exchange arrows, thrown spears and stones while closing. Shields up reduces losses; good archers suppress the enemy steerer.
3. **Grapple or break off.** Once alongside, grapple to board, or break off while you still can.
4. **Boarding.** Ordinary melee across two decks. The hostages below can be freed during the fight. Asgrim surrenders when half his crew falls or when the hostages are freed and his ship is lost.

Outcomes

Silver (three lots), hostages freed (refugees asking for shelter: roster pressure), Asgrim captured, killed or let go with his ship. Reading Heid's message to Asgrim, or letting him find it, plants his defection. **Consequences:** Orm's demand escalates to a direct threat; the freed hostages carry the household's name to the north; Asgrim's path splits. **Proof tests:** the player can break off before grappling; boarding resolves within ten minutes; the message is discoverable on every path that ends with the ship searched.

08 / Scenario 7: The Island With No Birds

Any open crossing, any chapter after the first raid, at most once per campaign. A short supernatural event proving the fairness contract.

Part	Content
Sign	An island where the chart shows none. No birds, no surf breaking on it, and a sweet smell on the wind.
Rule	It is the lyngbakr, the heather-backed beast. It surfaces where fish gather and sinks when disturbed.
Response	Steer off (safe); throw a food lot overboard to draw it under (safe, costs food); land (a short escape scene as the island tilts and sinks). Runa or Nessa can identify it if aboard.
Consequence	A story the crew tells for the rest of the game; landing and escaping is a famous deed (`Glory` approval); losing someone ashore is possible only if the player ignores two clear warnings.

09 / Scenario 8: The Answer

Chapter 5. The coast responds. The scenario is assembled from the deed ledger, so each player meets the answer they earned.

Which answer comes

Ledger contains	Answer
Fiachra shamed (`THREAT` or `TRIBUTE_TAKEN` at Carrick, Donnchad held)	Fergal's two ships raid Skarvholm at dawn
`SEED_TAKEN` and Ardcarn hungry	Ardcarn hires Gilla Ciaráin to burn the boatshed
`SACRED_TAKEN`	Kilbrecc's interdict: Christian markets refuse trade; envoy demands the Bell
`KILLING` with Glen Arra	Gilla Muire's archers ambush the next landing in Loch Arra
Ulf betrayed or humiliated	Ulf sells the household's watch pattern to Orm
`CIVILIAN_KILLED` known to a faction	That faction declares the household outlaws: its guards attack on sight, it pays Gilla Ciaráin to hunt the ship, and its allies close their markets
`SURRENDERED_KILLED` known twice or more	That faction's fighters stop surrendering to the household
Mostly fair dealing	An envoy, not a raid: a demand for compensation, with a chance to settle

Defence of Skarvholm

If an attack comes, it is a defence scene: the watch cairn on Rook Hill gives warning in proportion to how it is staffed; the broch is the last refuge; the boatshed and the ship are what the attackers want to burn. Attackers have aims and withdraw when they have achieved them or lost cohesion. They can be talked to under a truce.

Settling instead of fighting

Every answer includes a way to settle: compensation in goods, returning what was taken, freeing a hostage, public apology at a named place, or service. Settling writes `PROMISE_MADE` and changes the council in Chapter 7. **Proof tests:** the answer chosen matches the ledger; a player with no grievances gets an envoy; every attack can be settled

before or during the fight.

10 / Scenario 9: The Return to Skarvholm

Chapter 8, required. Long after the household left, Orm's garrison holds the island, the beaches have drowned, and Heid's apprentice is digging into the Hollow Cairn for the one thing that can renew Manannán's compact. The household must go back.

Lead

At the Gathering, Brónach tells the council that the old compact was sworn over **Manannán's Cup**, which the cairn-builders laid in the Hollow Cairn. Without it the compact cannot be renewed and Manannán's mist will not cover the alliance. The same week, word comes that Orm's ships took Skarvholm (about day 228) and that Gróa is digging at the cairn. **Confidence:** certain about the Cup's place; likely about the garrison.

True state

Element	Truth
Garrison	About 40 fighters under Kolgrím the Burner, placed as in Book 9 section 08; three dogs; a horn on Rook Hill
Ships	Two of Orm's ships at Naust Cove; a reinforcement ship at Kaldness, called by the horn
The dig	Gróa, four guards and six conscripted diggers (civilians from a taken harbour) at the cairn; her shaft has broken into the central chamber
The cairn	The cairn's keepers are awake and angry; two diggers drowned in the broken chamber and walk as draugr
Captives	Any residents left as an outpost are held in the broch fort
The Cup	On its stone in the inner chamber. It leaves the stone only after three truths are spoken at the Door. Lifting it makes Rán's tide surge across the island

Known intel and how to improve it

- **Brónach:** the Cup and the Door's rule: "Say three true things you would rather not say."
- **Thrand, or Asgrim if he has defected:** garrison strength, the horn, the reinforcement time.
- **What the household learned in Year 1:** that Gull Geo is hidden from Rook Hill; the Seal Cave passage, if that puzzle was solved; the Grey Men alignment that opens the east door, if learned.
- **Scouting from a fishing boat:** the cell sentry at night, the patrol loop.
- **Nessa:** as Watcher or Runaway, her seals report the patrols. As Bound, she may already have told Heid about Gull Geo, which is why the cell sentry exists.

Preparation

Choose the approach, the party (sized by approach), the timing and one advantage: **Thrand's signals** (a false horn call holds the garrison for a minute), **an allied diversion** (needs two committed allies), **Nessa's seals** (patrol warnings), or **fire arrows** (to burn the ships at Naust). A labelled checkpoint is made before landing.

Approaches

Approach	How it plays	Needs
A Gull Geo by night	Land unseen, silence or slip past the cell sentry, cross the bog in the peat banks' cover, reach the cairn from the north	Night; up to 6
B The Seal Cave passage	Enter the cave at spring low water and follow the tidal passage into the cairn's spring room, below Gróa's dig	The Year 1 passage; spring low tide; up to 4
C The Skerry causeway	Cross at spring low tide beside Orm's ships; burn them, then strike the cairn from the south-east	Spring low tide; up to 8
D Diversion	Allied ships attack Naust Cove; a small party goes in by A or C while the garrison is drawn off	Two committed allies
E Challenge Kolgrím	Call him out to a hólmganga on the Skerry at low tide. A champion (the steerer or a resident) fights him; the losing side yields the night	Kolgrím's pride; nerve

Inside the cairn

The broken chamber holds Gróa, the drowned diggers and the cairn's wardens. The **Door of Three Truths** offers a choice of statements drawn from the ledger and the household's secrets: some true, some plausible lies. The Door accepts only true things the household would rather not say: a massacre, an abandonment, a broken promise, a fear, Bran's old raid. A household with a clean record can speak of losses and failures. Each lie wakes a warden; three lies seal the Door until the next spring tide. Everyone present hears the truths, and their memories and regard change accordingly. Gróa can be fought, captured or persuaded to stop; her diggers can be freed or killed.

Complications (one drawn per seed)

- **Early reinforcement:** Orm's reinforcement ship is already offshore.
- **Fog:** a thick fog halves sight for everyone; whose fog it is depends on the bargains.
- **Heid comes for the Cup** in sea-light, if she has not been turned. She can be fought or talked down with Asgrim's evidence or the release of Breccán's crew.
- **The captives are moved:** the garrison begins loading the captives onto the ships; there is a short window to free them.

Two features are always present: the drowned diggers, and the surge when the Cup is lifted.

Extraction

Once the Cup is lifted, Rán's surge rises on the Book 10 timers: tidal ground first, then the Seal Cave passage, then the causeway, then the strand. Exits from the inner chamber: back through the spring room to Seal Cave, out through the east door towards Gull Geo or Naust Cove, or up Gróa's shaft into the middle of the garrison. Freeing captives costs time against the surge.

Outcome bands

Band	Result
The Cup, unseen	Recovered with no alarm; the garrison finds out at dawn
The Cup by force	Recovered after the horn; losses; the ships burned or not
The Cup and the captives	Recovered and the household's people brought home
The Cup lost	Gróa forces the Door with blood after the household withdraws; Heid gains the Cup. Orm's weather is at its strongest; the United Coast is no longer reachable

Band	Result
Withdrawal	No Cup. One retry before day 255, against a garrison half again as strong, with dogs at the cell

Consequences

- **The Cup recovered:** the compact can be renewed at Inis Rón; Manannán's mist can cover the alliance in the finale.
- **Ships burned:** Orm's fleet sails two ships short.
- **Beacon lit:** if the watch on Rook Hill lights its beacon, Orm's fleet sails five days early and the last preparation window shrinks.
- **Captives freed:** they return as residents with high regard. **Diggers freed** is `RESCUE`; **diggers killed** is `CIVILIAN_KILLED`, known to Orm's conscripts and fatal to their chances of defecting.
- **Truths spoken:** the crew's memories and regard change; secrets one resident held become shared.
- **Kolgrím:** killed in the hólmganga, his garrison's cohesion collapses for the night; killed later, his men fight to the end.
- **Skarvholm afterwards** belongs to Rán and cannot be resettled, but the household's dead can be given rites, and Thorkel can be laid to rest.
- The steerer's death anywhere on the expedition is game over, returning to the pre-landing checkpoint.

Proof tests

1. Each approach recovers the Cup on at least one seed; B only at spring low tide.
2. The Door accepts exactly the ledger-true statements; three lies seal it until the next spring tide.
3. Surge timers match Book 10, and at least two exits from the inner chamber are reachable before they close.
4. Failure leaves the campaign winnable, without the United Coast, and offers exactly one retry.
5. The expedition is hard: the autoplay "good player" policy recovers the Cup on its first attempt in no more than 60% of seeds.

11 / Consequence chains

The game's memory is easiest to test as chains: one choice, carried by real people, arriving later as a different scene.

Example chains

Choice	Carried by	Arrives as	Visible to the player
Seed left at Carrick	Colla tells Muiredach	Muiredach speaks for the household at the council	Steward's report: "Ardcarn will sow this spring"
Seed taken	Ardcarn's failed sowing	Hungry refugees in Year 2; Gilla Ciaráin hired	Rumours at Saltvik; refugees name the sail
Ferryman's promise	Manannán's bargain	Thrand arrives; keeping him keeps the mist	The promise listed in the bargains panel
Bell borrowed and returned	Colmán and Muirenn	Kilbrecc offers sanctuary and mediation	Muirenn's annal entry read at the council
Bell stolen	Breccán's crew and Kilbrecc	Nightly drowned; interdict; council demand	Fog and footprints; refused trade
Ulf stopped at Carrick	Ulf's grudge, Colla's gratitude	Ulf's enmity; Ardcarn's respect	Ulf's remark at Saltvik

Choice	Carried by	Arrives as	Visible to the player
Heid's message found	Asgrim	Asgrim's defection in Chapter 7	The message in the evidence panel
Massacre at Carrick, unwitnessed	Nobody, unless evidence links it	Ulf is blamed; the household's crew remember	Residents' remarks; Ulf's fury when accused
Massacre at Carrick, witnessed	The escaping runner	Outlawry from Dún Fiach; guards attack on sight on the Irish coast	Hostile territory on the region map
Seal Cave passage found in Year 1	The household's own knowledge	A hidden way into the Hollow Cairn in the Return	The passage on the island map
Bound Nessa told Heid of Gull Geo	Nessa's seals	A sentry at the hermit's cell in the Return	The sentry's light at night
An outpost kept on Skarvholm	Orm's capture of the island	Captives in the broch fort in the Return	Their names in the morning report

Propagation rules

- News travels only with carriers: survivors, traders, monks, rival crews, seals for the Keepers. Each carrier has a route and a delay.
- A deed's identification depends on what witnesses saw: sail, shields, stem carving, faces, voices.
- Repainting the sail or unshipping the stem reduces identification on later deeds, not earlier ones.

Balance check across approaches

Over Chapters 2 to 5, simulated with Book 2's autoplay harness, each approach family (theft, threat, tribute, trade, rescue, fight) must produce a different but competitive mix of goods, contacts, crew approval and future risk. Fail the gate if any single approach dominates on every measure, if mercy is always the poorer choice materially by the end of Chapter 5, or if the brutal policy is not both effective in the short term and costly by Chapter 5.